

Surprise Wins Shake Up the China Open

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The China Open tennis **tournament** in Beijing has been full of surprises. World number two Aryna Sabalenka lost to Nikola Bartunkova, the BBC reports. Bartunkova is 20 years old, comes from the Czech Republic and is **ranked** 34th. She won 6-4, 6-3.

Just one day earlier, world number one Elena Rybakina also lost. She was beaten by Alina Charaeva of Armenia, who is **ranked** 118th.

It is the first time since 2015 that the top two players both left the China Open this early.

"She's a legend, so I'm really happy that I won the match," Bartunkova said.

Sabalenka won two big **tournaments** in March, but she has not won a title since then. During the match, she threw her racquet in frustration.

Other stars kept winning, including **Wimbledon** champion Linda Noskova and Naomi Osaka. Rybakina said she will skip the Wuhan Open to rest a hurt foot.

Word Treasure

tournament -- A competition with many matches.

ranked -- Given a number that shows how good a player is compared with others.

Wimbledon -- A famous tennis tournament in England.

Break it down

Sabalenka loses at the China Open

Rybakina also loses

A rare event since 2015

Bartunkova's reaction

Sabalenka's year

Other players and Rybakina's injury

Why it matters

It shows that in sports, rising young players can beat famous stars.

Test what you remember

1. Who beat Aryna Sabalenka?

- ☐ (A) Naomi Osaka
- ☐ (B) Elena Rybakina
- ☐ (C) Linda Noskova
- ☐ (D) Nikola Bartunkova

2. How old is Bartunkova?

- ☐ (A) 15
- ☐ (B) 30
- ☐ (C) 20
- ☐ (D) 42

3. What was the score?

- ☐ (A) 6-4, 6-3
- ☐ (B) 6-1, 6-2
- ☐ (C) 6-0, 6-0
- ☐ (D) 7-5, 7-5

4. Who beat world number one Elena Rybakina?

- ☐ (A) Bartunkova
- ☐ (B) Alina Charaeva
- ☐ (C) Osaka
- ☐ (D) Sabalenka

5. What did Bartunkova call Sabalenka?

- ☐ (A) A beginner
- ☐ (B) A legend
- ☐ (C) Her coach
- ☐ (D) Her sister

6. Why will Rybakina skip the Wuhan Open?

- ☐ (A) Because it was canceled
- ☐ (B) To rest a hurt foot
- ☐ (C) To go on vacation
- ☐ (D) Because she won it already

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: C 3: A 4: B 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):